

We Lost the Tail; Is the Brain Next?

A million years ago, humans lost the tail. Will the brain lose its functions next, thanks to artificial intelligence?

In recent years, there have been dramatic improvements in artificial intelligence (AI) underpinned by several technological advances. They will continue to take longer strides with even more developments and substantial progress in the coming years. And, as this happens, we are also creating (unknowingly) various risks to our socio-economic structure, civilisation in general, and to some extent for human species.

Species-level risks are not evident yet; however, the other two, socio-economic and civilisation level risks are too significant to be ignored. From a business perspective, several risks could affect business metrics adversely. For now, let us talk about general outcome risks that can have a significant impact on critical social, civil and business aspects.

One of the things we are not considering is modular advancements that could soon build up this risk multifold. If you have experience in module developments, such as programming or using building blocks of some kind, it will be more apparent. Making the first few building blocks takes a lot of time and effort. However, as we build those blocks, the next build becomes more straightforward, more comfortable and faster. And within no time, the overall build becomes much faster and easier.

It is the same with AI developments. So far, several significant building blocks have been developed and are in progress. When we stitch them together, the capability of AI will increase multifold, which should be a more significant concern for us.

The more concerning part is about the risks that we have not thought of

yet. If you had asked people in the 18th century what significant risks to the civilisation were, they wouldn't have said nukes or guns; it was far-fetched for them. We are probably in the same situation as them, and we don't know what we don't know, a classic example of *hypocognition*.

There are several risks that this AI crusade is bringing with it. We may not be able to avoid all of them, but we can understand them so we can address them.

At present, many AI solutions are pure junk

Our over-enthusiasm for new technologies has somehow colluded our quality expectations. So much so that we have almost stopped demanding the right quality solutions. We are so fond of this newness that we are ignoring flaws in new technologies.

This attitude is encouraging subpar solutions day by day, resulting in a pile of junk solutions, which is growing faster than ever. The disturbing part of that is those who are making subpar solutions are unable to understand this issue either.

Shouldn't we be challenging junk AI solutions?

Merely pushing for more technology solutions without paying attention to quality of those solutions adds a lot of garbage out in the field. This garbage, when out there in the market, easily creates disillusionment and, in turn, adds to the resistance for healthy adoption.



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